



**Is Less...
More?**

GEN Z AND BRAND REPUTATION

Meet Our Team.



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ROMINA VELAZQUEZ



FINLEY DOWDELL

The Contradiction.

**Gen Z claims to care deeply about ethics, so
why do controversial brands continue to
thrive?**

Cancel Culture



STARBUCKS™



SHEIN



rain

rheggg why are we getting starbucks again after boycotting them??

2-22 Reply

16



eemz

boycott starbucks

2-23 Reply

View 1 reply

74

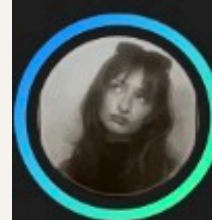


CLAUDIA

the way u acknowledged comments in the past abt starbucks by saying you weren't aware to STILL purchasing from there.. omg u r so embarrassing?

2-22 Reply

37



Samantha

Whyyyyy are we getting Starbucks fr

2-22 Reply

View 25 replies

626



Peter Tatchell Foundation
<https://petertatchellfoundation.org>



Protest as Chick-fil-A opens first London restaurant



Sol

You're still giving them money? Gross.

2025-1-1 Reply

113



View 38 replies



Facebook · The Advocate
150+ reactions · 11 months ago



Chick-fil-A has become synonymous with homophobia — but how much of the ...



Home > Life

Chick-fil-A says it'll stop donating to some anti-LGBTQ groups. But its CEO is still anti-LGBTQ.

This changes nothing.

By [Caitlin Welsh](#) on November 19, 2019



Yale Climate Connections
<https://yaleclimateconnections.org>



Shein is officially the biggest polluter in fast fashion



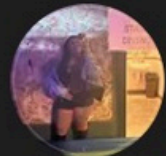
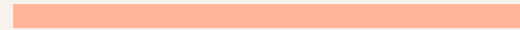
SHEIN



BBC
<https://www.bbc.com>



The truth behind your \$12 dress: Inside the Chinese factories fuelling Shein's success



Kiki

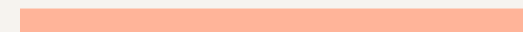
I had to stop buying. I couldn't in good conscience

2025-1-14 Reply

♡ 279



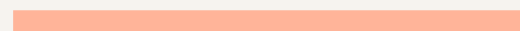
— View 14 replies ▾



Ethically Dressed
<https://ethically-dressed.com>

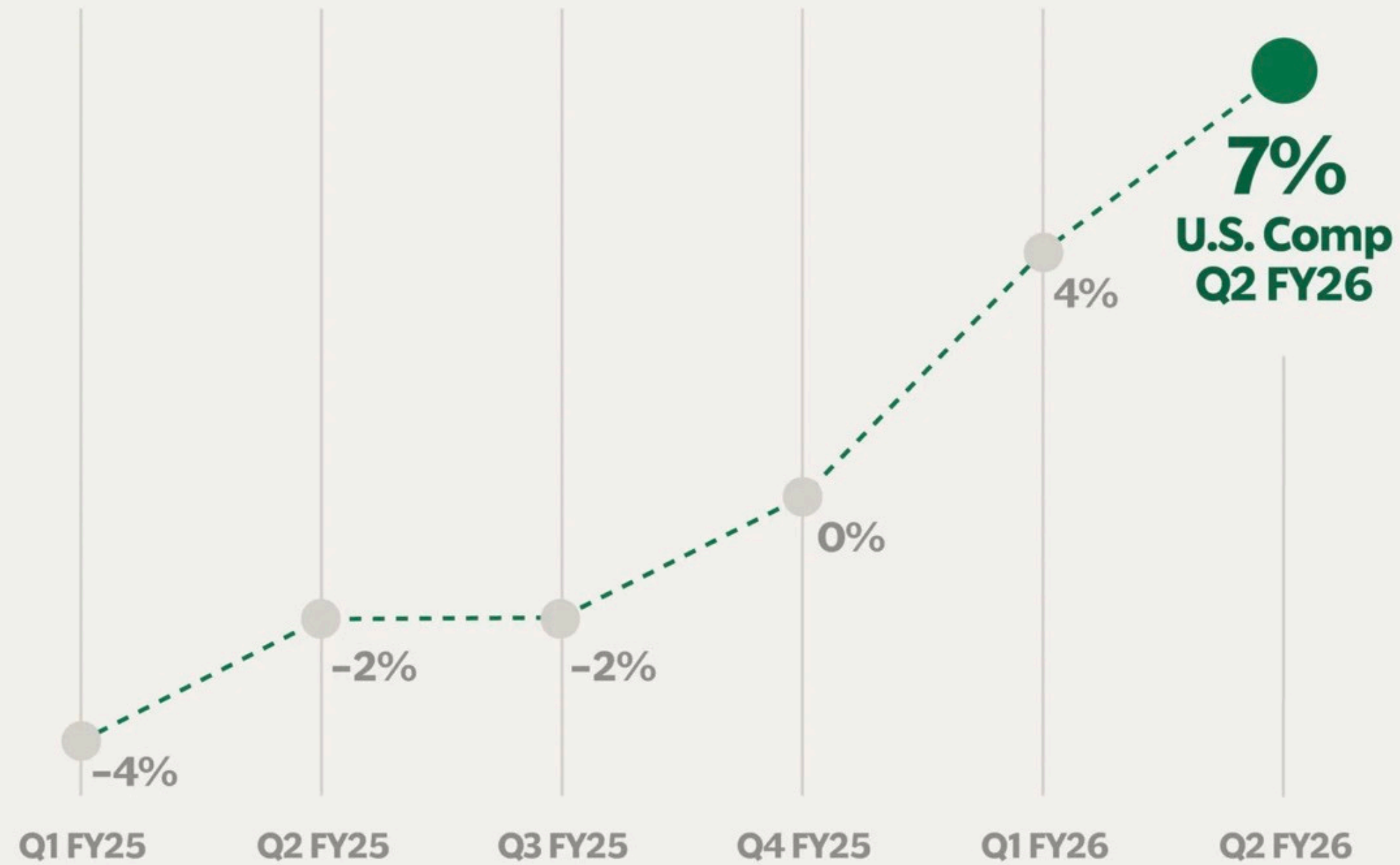


40+ Businesses Shein Stole Designs From:
The Complete List





Starbucks Momentum Accelerates



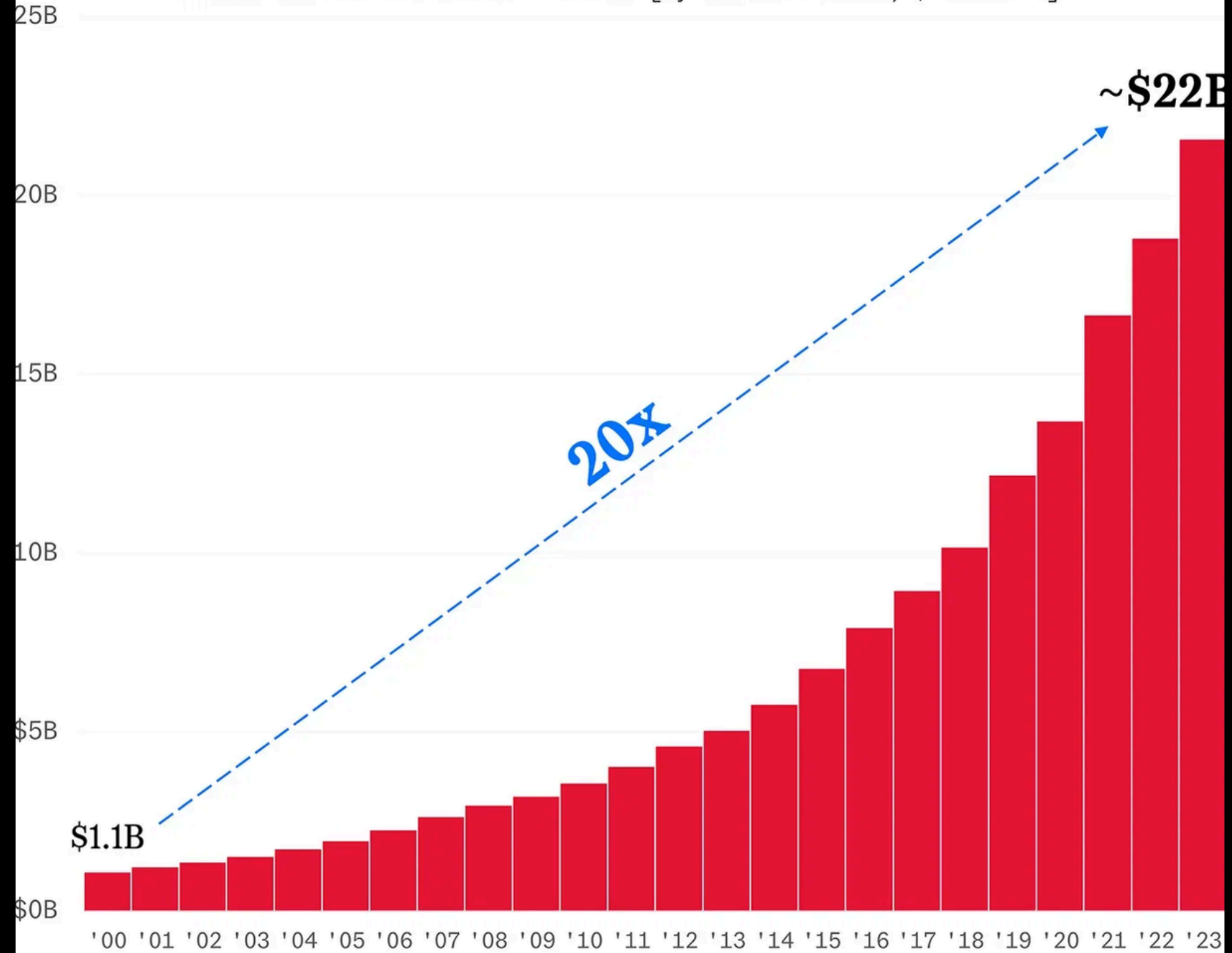
U.S. Comp Store Sales



GOLDEN NUGGETS

Keeps Selling More And More Chicken

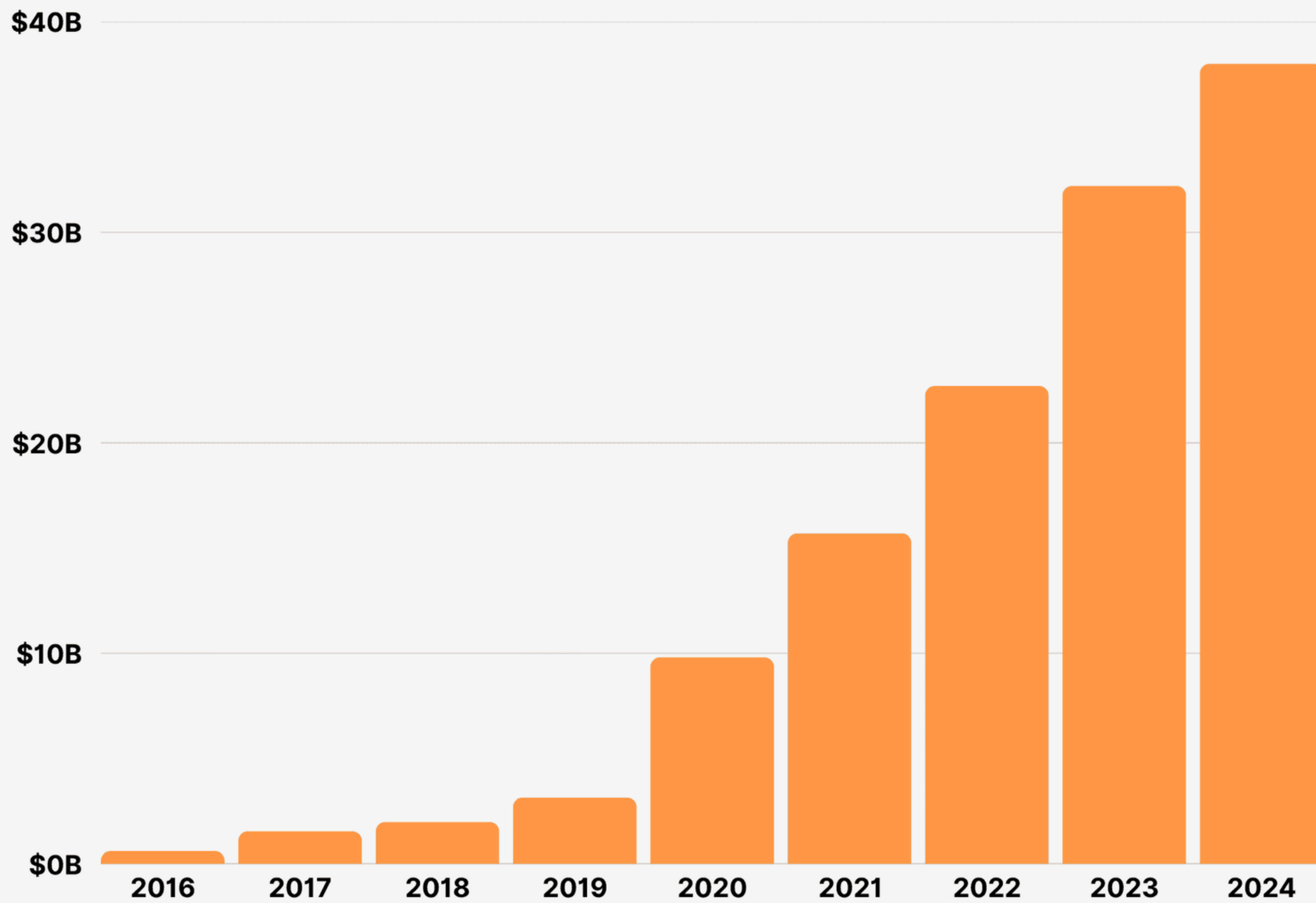
Annual Restaurant Sales Volumes [System-wide sales, \$ billions]



CHART

Source: Company filings, WSJ, QSR, Various media reports

Shein Revenue



How is this possible?

These brands are...

EASY TO ACCESS

PART OF DAILY ROUTINES

SOCIALLY RELEVANT

UNWAVERING



“I still buy from Starbucks every day, even though I don’t represent what they stand for.”

Piper, 22

“I worked for Chick-Fil-A for a year, even though I don’t represent the organizations that they support. A lot of my friends are the same way.”

Jonas, 17

Grey Rock Method



BRANDY  MELVILLE





Teen Vogue

<https://www.teenvogue.com> › Style › fashion

Brandy Melville Documentary Details Racism, Misogyny ...

Apr 10, 2024 — **Brandy Hellville**” director Eva Orner talks to Teen Vogue about the new documentary about the fast fashion retailer.

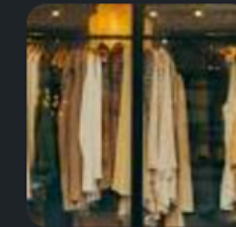


Body Positive Alliance

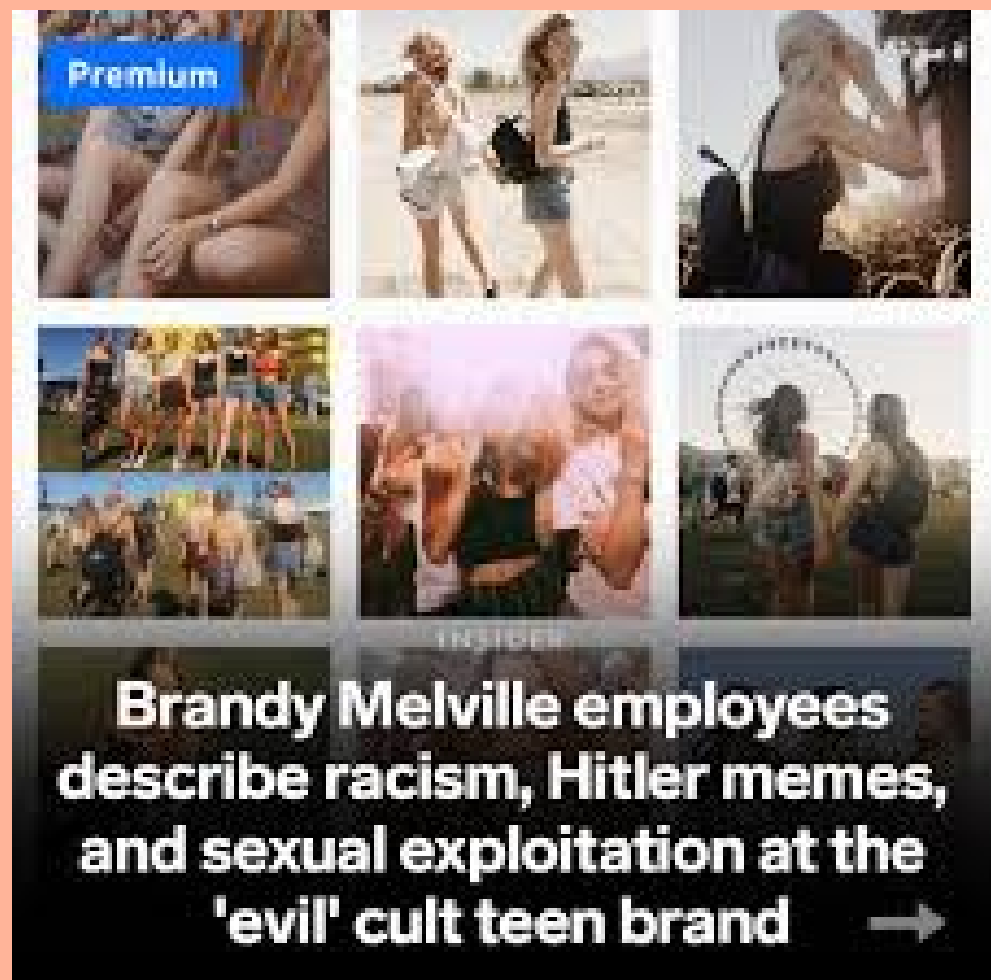
<https://bodypositivealliance.org> › blog › brands-like-br...

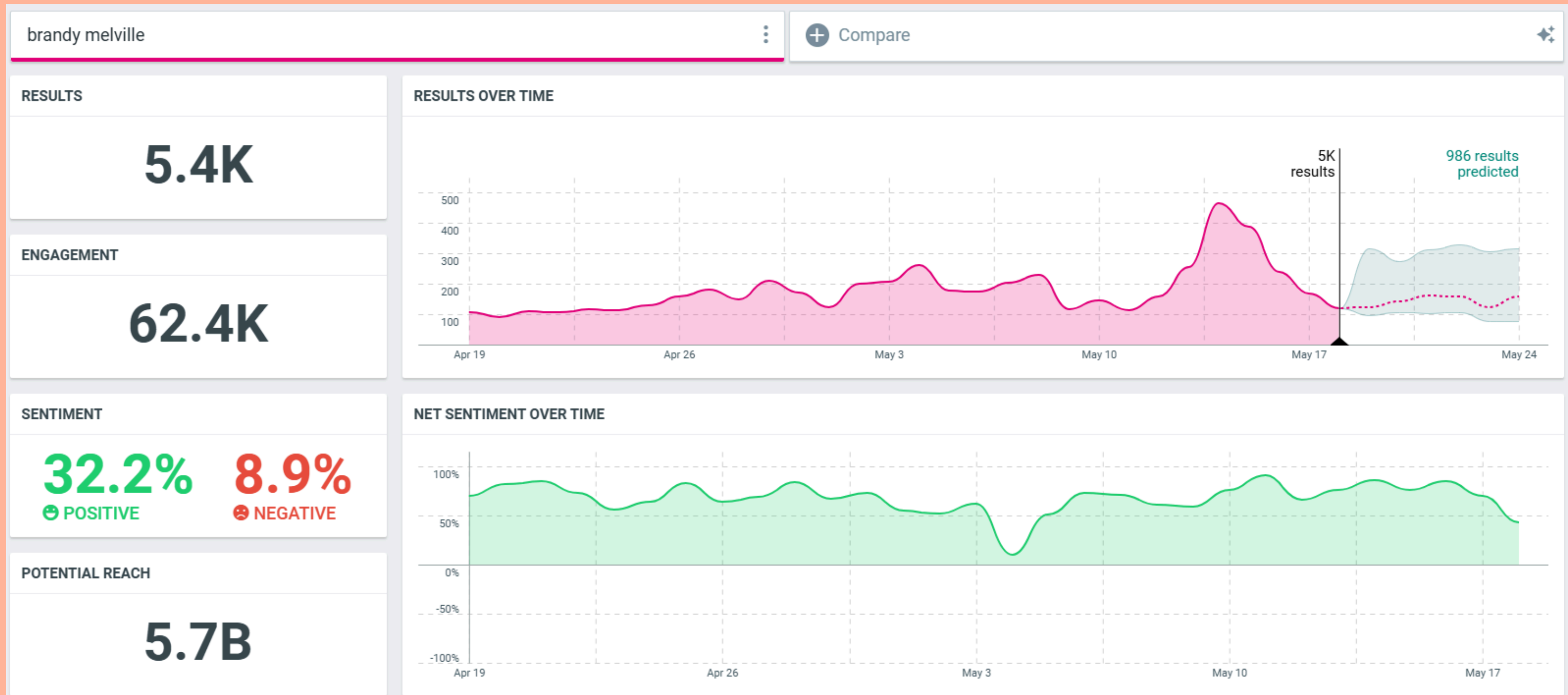
Brands like Brandy Melville are body shaming us

Feb 7, 2023 — **Brands like Brandy Melville are body shaming us** ... Body Positive Alliance is a student-led 501(c)(3) non-profit organization that spreads body ... [Read more](#)



PR nightmare?





Sentiment is mostly positive, despite controversy.

Goldilocks Zone

That “just right” space where a brand is present, but not desperately trying to fit in.

**“WHEN BRANDS HOP ON EVERY MICRO-TREND, IT FEELS LIKE
THEY HAVE NO VISION.”**

NATALY, 20

“YOU CAN TELL WHEN THEY’RE JUST FOLLOWING THE HERD.”

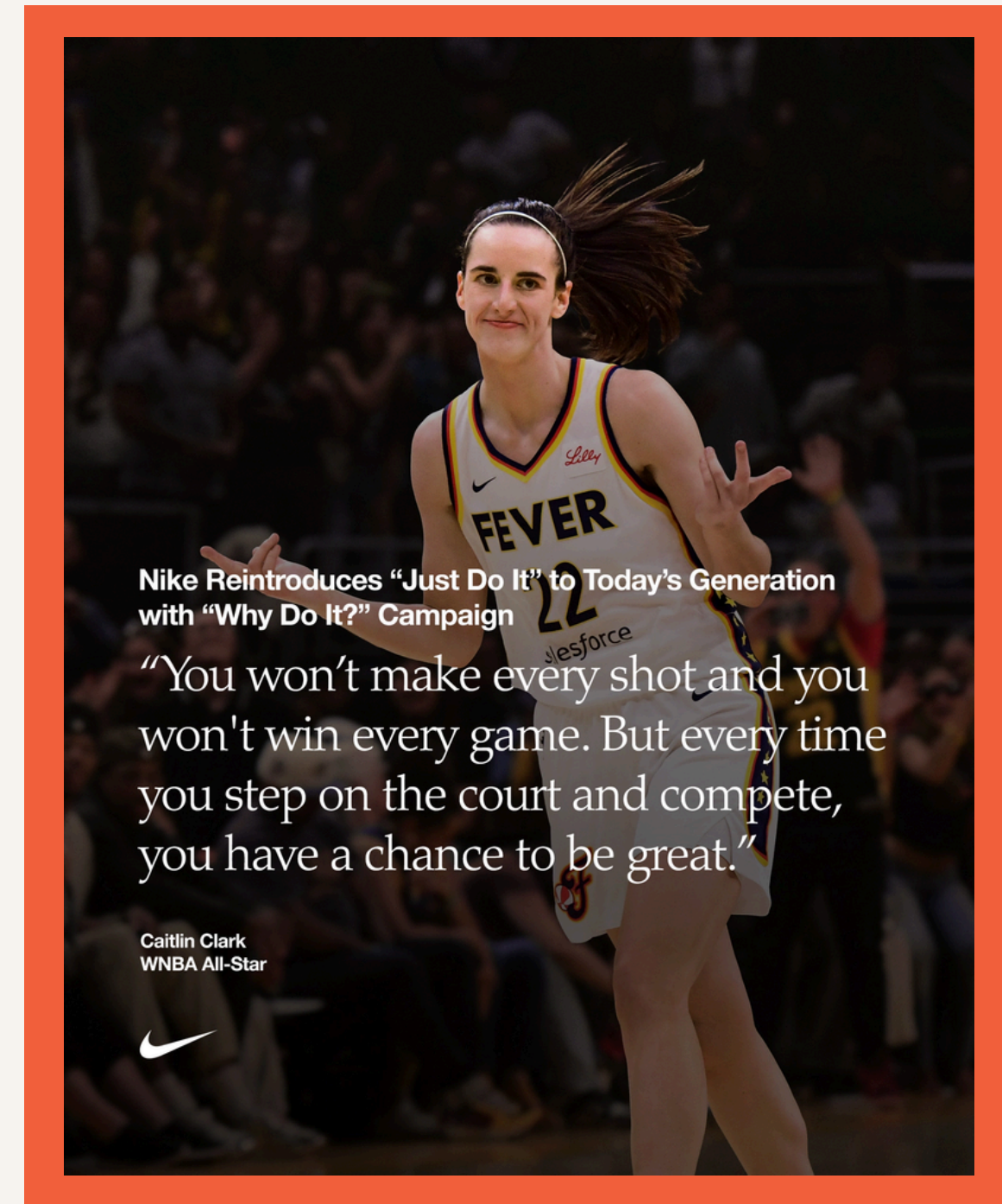
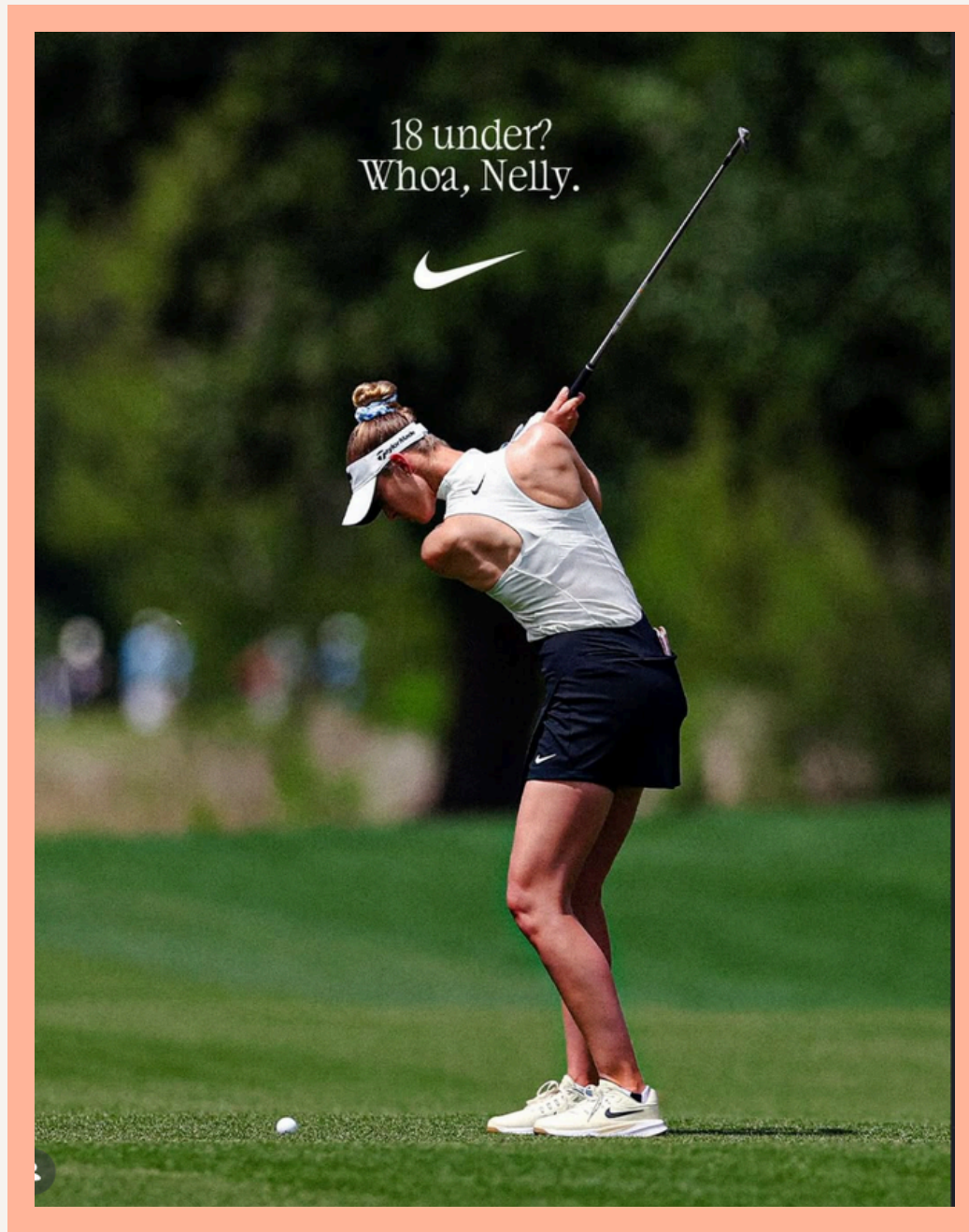
CRISTAL, 21

Here's what NOT to do.



“it’s giving Y2K
divaaaaaa 🖍️”

JUST DOing IT right with Gen Z



Even Nike can't RUN from backlash



Key Metrics

nike

⋮

+ Compare

RESULTS

571.5K

ENGAGEMENT

7.8M

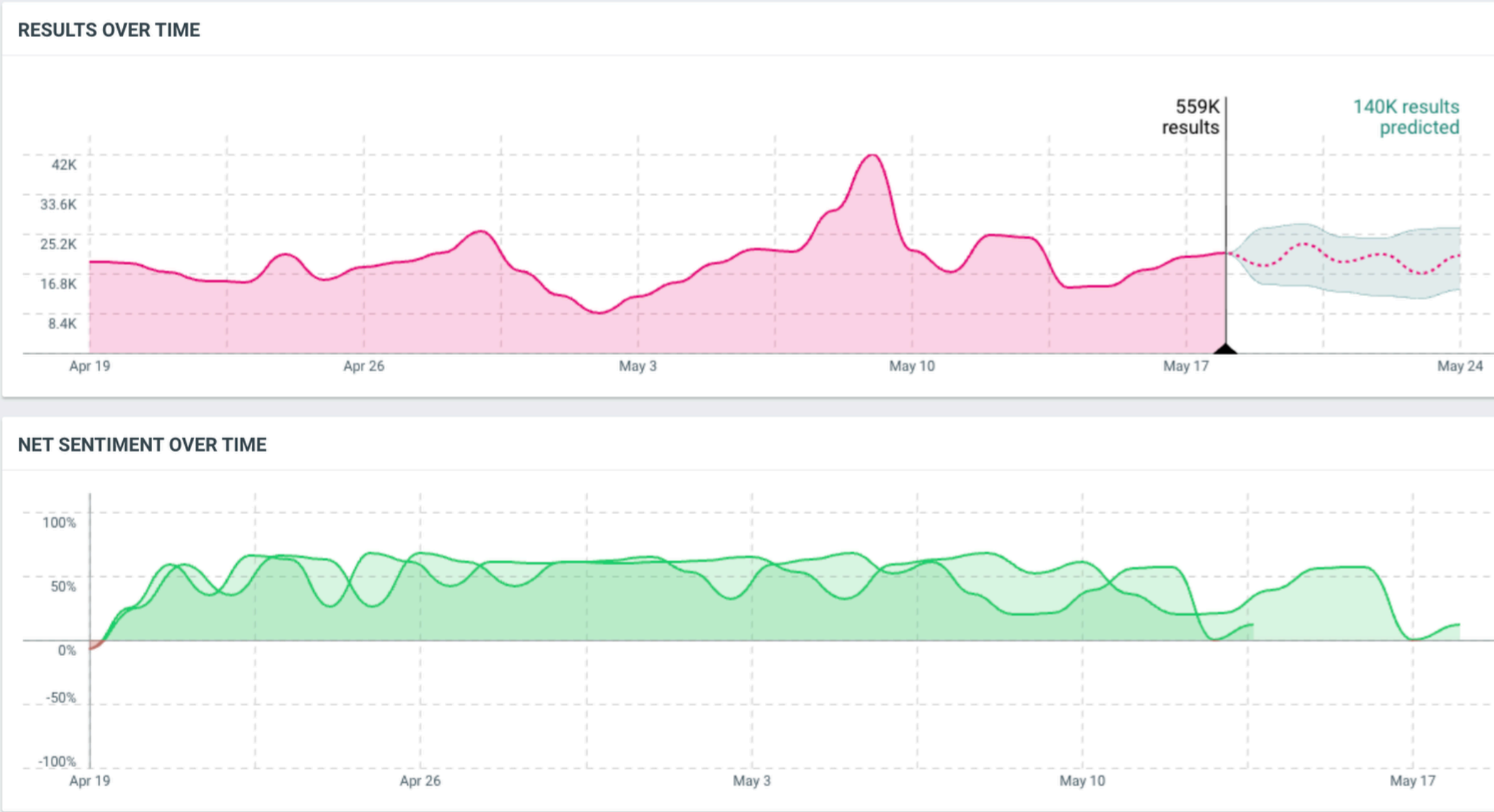
SENTIMENT

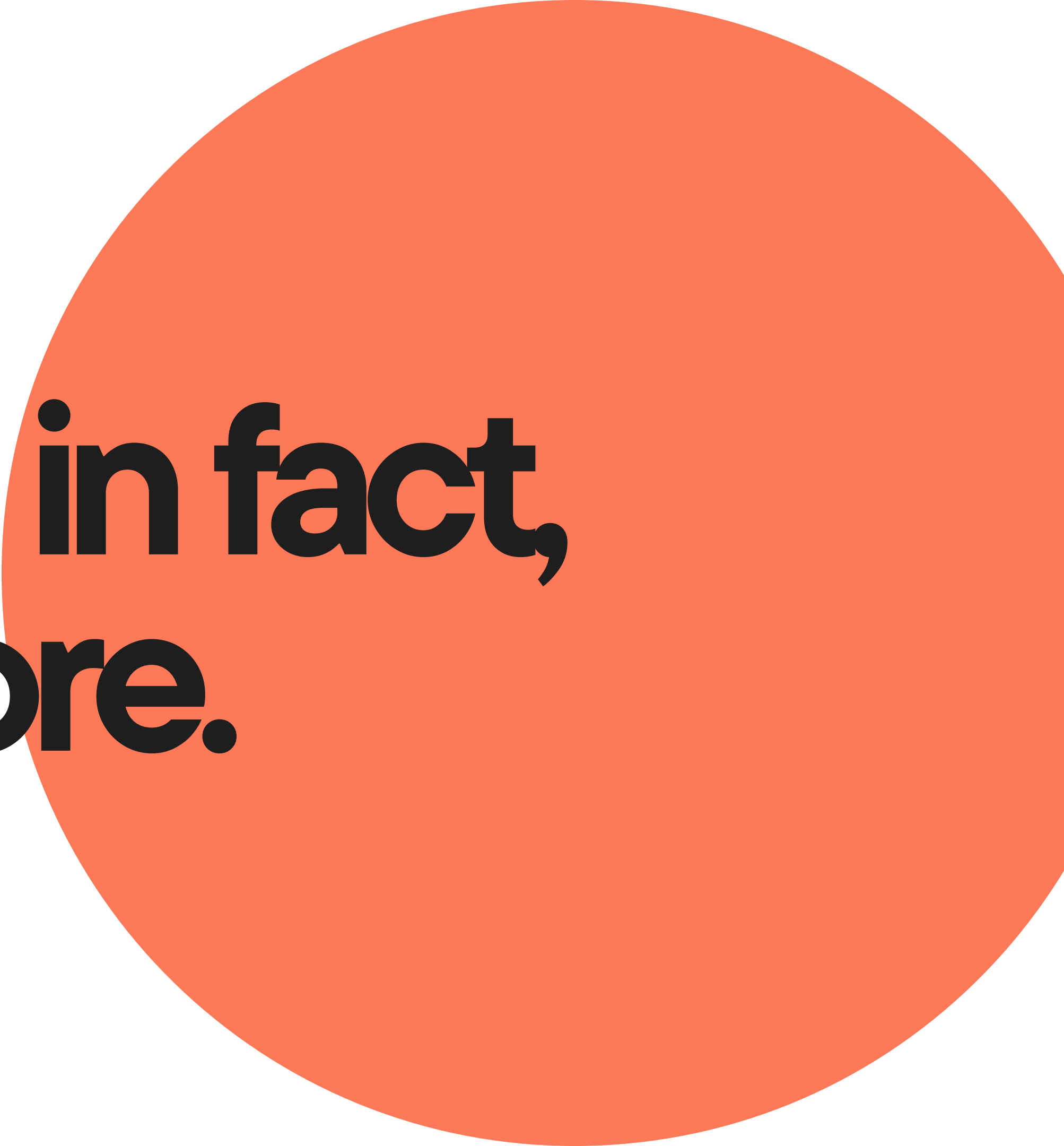
27.7%
😊 POSITIVE

13.1%
😞 NEGATIVE

POTENTIAL REACH

913.2M





**Less is, in fact,
more.**

Cancel Culture

Creates online criticism, but does not always impact long-term loyalty.

Grey Rock Method

Brands can reduce backlash by avoiding unnecessary emotional engagement.

Goldilocks Zone

Don't over do it. Find your brands individual voice.

Questions?